Ministry of Water, Land and Resource Stewardship

Flood Warning – Fraser Valley East including Sumas River and Chilliwack River
Issued: 3:45 PM December 10, 2025

The River Forecast Centre is **maintaining** a Flood Warning for:

- Sumas River, including spillover from the Nooksack River
- Lower Fraser tributaries including the Chilliwack River, Skagit River, Coquihalla River and other areas of the Fraser Valley around Abbotsford, Chilliwack, Hope and east through Manning Park

Weather Synopsis:

A series of atmospheric rivers is impacting the United States Pacific Northwest and the south and central coasts of British Columbia through this week. The most recent storm started overnight Tuesday/Wednesday and is expected to continue through the day on Wednesday. While the highest precipitation amounts for these storms are expected for Washington and Oregon, there is the possibility of heavier amounts moving into British Columbia. Environment and Climate Change Canada have issued orange level rainfall warnings through the region, identifying total precipitation amounts today 80 to 110 mm in the Lower Mainland, and potentially above 110 mm over higher terrain south and east of Hope out towards Manning Park.

Temperatures are rising through Wednesday, with freezing levels forecasted to rise to 2500 m elevation. Shallow snowpack is being observed around the mid and upper elevations of the region, with conditions to produce rain-on-snow and additional streamflow runoff.

River Conditions:

River levels are elevated from rainfall earlier in the week, and are now rising further in response to the ongoing storm.

The Nooksack River has reached minor flood stage at Cedarville and Ferndale. Current stage (2:15PM) at the USGS gauge at Cedarville is 146.8ft. Revised forecasts from the Northwest River Forecast Center are projecting a peak level of 150.1ft later this evening, and remain above flood stage through Thursday afternoon. This is a similar level as observed during the November 2021 flood event at Cedarville, and a similar flow forecast as the 1990 flood event

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Water levels on the Nooksack River at Everson (as of 2:00PM) have reached 83.17ft, and overland flow and spill is being observed at the Nooksack River overflow at Emerson Road.

High flows are expected across the Fraser Valley, including the Chilliwack River and surrounding areas. Flows may reach or exceed the 10-year to 20-year return period range, or higher. Current flows (3:30PM Wednesday) on the Chilliwack River above Slesse Creek, at the Vedder Crossing and in Slesse Creek are estimated to be at a 2-year to 5-year flow, however streamflow gauging is showing difficulties with accuracy.

Heavy rain and high streamflow bring increased risk for unstable banks, river erosion, submerged roads, swift water hazards, flooding and landslides. Stay clear of the banks of swift running rivers and never drive across flooded roads, bridges or river crossings. At this time of year leaves can clog storm drains and impact urban drainage. Keep storm drains clear.

Review personal flood emergency plans and be prepared to implement if needed. Information on local flood response, including evacuation alerts and orders, is available from local governments and First Nations.

The River Forecast Centre continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

For information on how to prepare for flood hazards, visit PreparedBC.

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A ***High Streamflow Advisory*** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Fast-flowing bodies of water increase risk to life safety. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A ***Flood Watch*** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A ***Flood Warning*** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.